

Switching pages

Kodu's "switch page" feature allows programmers to make characters behave differently at different points in the game. For instance, at first, bumping a starfish might make it move away – as per a rule on Page 1 of its program. Another rule on Page 1 might make the program switch to Page 2 after 20 seconds. The rule on Page 2 might then tell the starfish to shoot purple missiles when it's bumped.

▽ Terrain

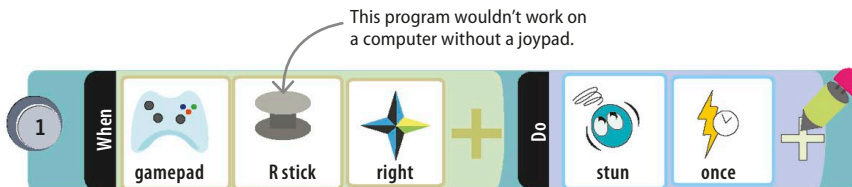
Kodu allows users to create the terrain of their world by painting in different types of terrain blocks. It's also possible to add features such as water, hills, and walls.

This game world has various different types of terrain.



Why Kodu?

Kodu may be easier for younger children as it's more symbol based than Scratch. It allows children to develop computational thinking skills while creating games. Kodu puts the emphasis on inspiring creativity and making ideas come to life, while enabling kids to build up complex and detailed games. As with Scratch, users can share their games with the Kodu community.



△ Limitations

Being a language within a game, the range of programming that can be done with Kodu is more limited than with other languages. The available options and commands are purely related to gaming.

REAL WORLD

Kodu Kinect

It's possible to control the 3D world of Kodu using body movements or speech. Microsoft's Kinect controller Software Development Kit (SDK) allows programmers to write code that connects the Kinect's input to Kodu. This means that players can control characters with their voice, or make a character jump onscreen by jumping in real life. It does involve a reasonable amount of programming experience, so kids may require assistance from an adult.